



WEST CHESTER PRESCHOOL

A parent cooperative
preschool in West Chester,
Ohio

CURRICULUM GUIDE

OLDER FOUR / FIVE-YEAR-OLD CLASS · KINDERGARTEN READINESS

PRE-K CURRICULUM GUIDE

Kindergarten readiness is the key to our Pre-K program. Students continue to master the core content needed to become emergent in literacy, develop number sense, and build other basic skills. They are also exposed to additional conceptual ideas, expanding their knowledge through group learning and guided experimentation. These indicators describe the knowledge and skills that form the foundation for meaningful early learning.



Aligned with the Ohio Department of Education Early Learning Content Standards. Page references (p. NN) point to that document.



READING

PHONEMIC AWARENESS & WORD RECOGNITION

- Identify matching sounds and recognize rhymes in familiar stories, poems, finger plays, songs, and words (cat/hat, dog/frog) (p. 12)
- Hear sounds in words by isolating syllables using snapping, clapping, or rhythmic movement (p. 12)
- Recognize when words share phonemes and repeat the common phoneme (/b/ as in ball, Bob, baby) (p. 13)
- Recognize and name upper- and lower-case letters, including those in their first and last name (p. 13)
- Recognize that words are made up of letters (p. 13)
- Read their own first and last name
- Recognize and "read" familiar words or environmental print (p. 13)
- Show reading fluency through phrasing, intonation, and expression in shared reading (p. 13)

VOCABULARY

- Understand the meaning of new words from conversations, pictures, or concrete objects (p. 14)
- Recognize likenesses and differences in objects and pictures

READING PROCESS

- Understand that print has meaning — text provides information or tells a story (p. 16)
- Hold books upright; read front to back, top to bottom, words left to right (p. 16)
- Predict what might happen next during reading (p. 16)

- Answer literal questions to show comprehension of age-appropriate texts read aloud (p. 16)
- Respond to oral reading by commenting or questioning (p. 17)

READING APPLICATIONS

- Use pictures and illustrations to aid comprehension — informational text (p. 18)
- Identify characters in favorite books and stories (p. 19)
- Retell or re-enact events from a story (p. 19)
- Participate in shared reading of repetitious or predictable text (p. 19)



WRITING

WRITING PROCESS

- Generate ideas for a story or shared writing with assistance (p. 20)

WRITING APPLICATIONS

- Play at writing from top to bottom, in horizontal rows (p. 21)

WRITING CONVENTIONS

- Print letters of their own name and other meaningful words with assistance, using conventional print (p. 22)
- Begin to demonstrate letter formation in "writing" (p. 22)
- Scribble familiar words with mock letters and some actual letters (e.g., love, Mom, child's name) (p. 22)



COMMUNICATION

- Attend to speakers, stories, poems, and songs (p. 24)
- Follow simple oral directions (p. 24)
- Speak clearly and understandably to express ideas, feelings, and needs (p. 25)
- Initiate and sustain a conversation through turn taking (p. 25)
- State their parents' names
- Recite their home address
- Recite their telephone number
- Participate in the recitation of books, poems, chants, songs, and nursery rhymes (p. 25)



MATH

- Count to 20 in the context of daily activities (p. 29)
- Identify and name numerals 0–20 (p. 29)
- Identify penny, nickel, dime, and quarter, and recognize that coins have different values (p. 29)
- Count on (forward) using objects such as cards, number cubes, or dominoes with familiar dot patterns (p. 29)
- Begin to use the language of units of time (day, night, week; yesterday, today, tomorrow) (p. 30)
- Recognize that various devices measure time (clock, timer, calendar) (p. 30)
- Identify, name, create, and describe common two-dimensional shapes (circles, triangles, rectangles, squares) (p. 31)
- Identify, name, and describe three-dimensional objects in the child's own words (sphere/ball, cube/box) (p. 31)
- Identify, copy, extend, and create simple patterns or sequences of sounds, shapes, and motions (p. 32)
- Understand relative concepts (e.g., size, heavy, light, over, under)
- Differentiate between left and right



SOCIAL & EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Separate easily from parents
- Demonstrate self-confidence and willingly try new things
- Follow classroom rules and routines (p. 49)
- Transition between activities
- Demonstrate cooperative behaviors such as turn taking, sharing, comforting, and compromising (p. 41)
- Stay on task
- Respect authority
- Use self-control



FINE MOTOR

- Trace along a line
- Copy or draw from memory two-dimensional figures (e.g., circle, square, cross, "X")
- Use scissors to cut a straight line and a curved line
- Use a mature pencil grip
- Work a puzzle with ten or more pieces
- Use glue properly
- Draw a person (head, body, arms, legs, eyes, mouth, nose, hands, feet)



GROSS MOTOR

- Stand on one foot for 5 seconds
- Hop on the right and left foot (2 hops)
- Skip
- Walk a balance beam heel to toe
- Catch a ball
- Coordinate body movements
- Climb using alternating feet



MUSIC & ART

- Participate during group singing
- Respond to rhythmic activities
- Identify colors
- Participate in art activities
- Use materials correctly
- Identify the intended purpose of familiar tools (e.g., scissors, hammer, paint brush, cookie cutter) (p. 40)
- Demonstrate the safe use of tools such as scissors, hammers, and writing utensils, with adult guidance (p. 40)



CONCEPTUAL AREAS INTRODUCED DURING THE YEAR



SCIENCE & HEALTH

EARTH & SPACE SCIENCE

Weather

Seasons

Environmental changes

Night and day

Planets

Motion

LIFE SCIENCE

Needs of living things

Classifying animals

Life cycles (e.g., butterflies, insects)

Plants

Living environments (air, water, soil)

Dinosaurs

PHYSICAL SCIENCE

Nature of matter (parts and wholes)

Sensory experiences

Vibration

Forces and motion (e.g., pulleys)

Light

HEALTH SCIENCE

Healthy habits (e.g., washing hands)

Dental health

Our bodies

Explore objects, organisms, and events using simple equipment (e.g., magnets and magnifiers).



SOCIAL STUDIES

HISTORY

Daily life (personal / family history)

Heritage (e.g., All About Me, family stories)

GOVERNMENT

U.S. symbols (e.g., American flag, Pledge of Allegiance)

Classroom rules

Authority figures at home, school, and in the community (e.g., teachers, parents, police officers)

CULTURE

Traditions

Holidays

GEOGRAPHY

Different locations and environments

Maps